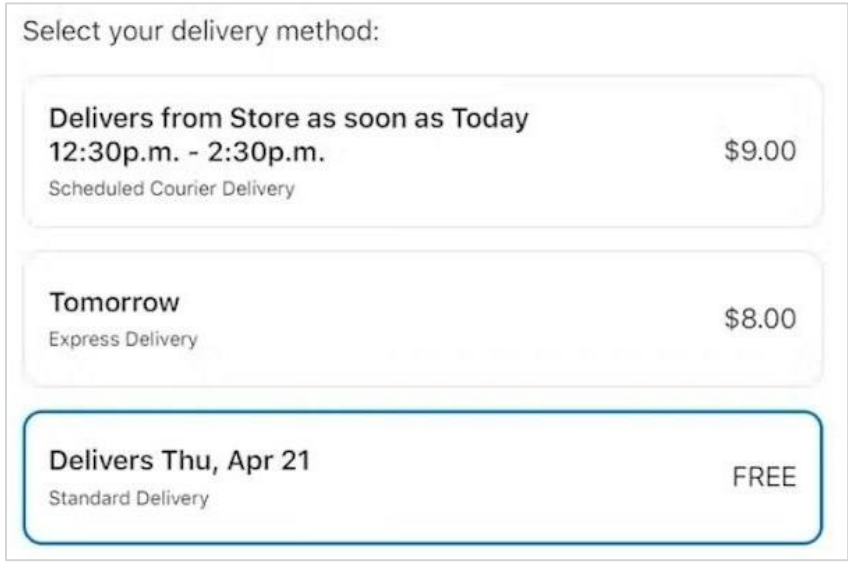
# Why good UI feels good

*and why AI slop doesn't*




Zeki Erman · BİL 333 Mesleki Yabancı Dil-1 · 12 November 2026

*Merriam-Webster, word of the year 2025*

# slop

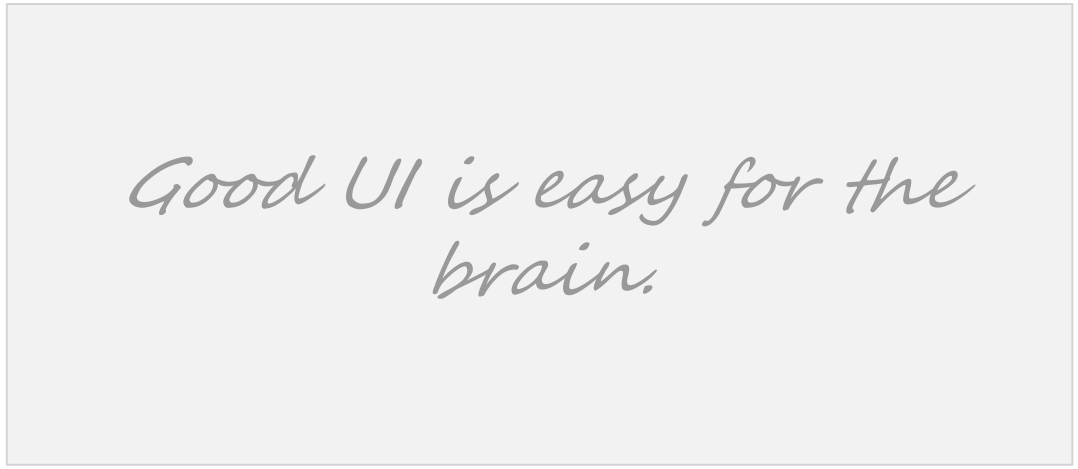
"digital content of low quality that is produced usually in quantity by means of artificial intelligence"

*I can spot it in a second. Why?*

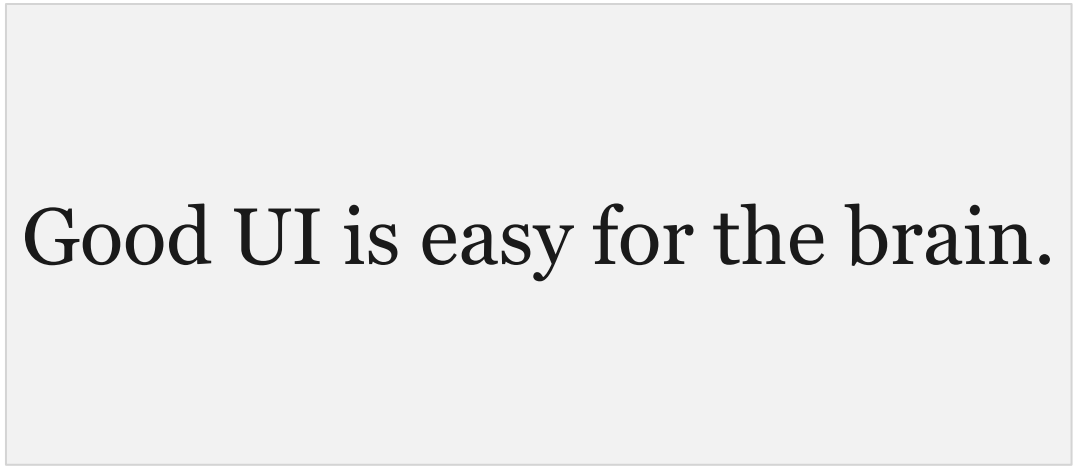



*AI-made ad for "Willy's Chocolate Experience", Glasgow 2024. Read the words. Image: Wikipedia, "AI slop"*

# The brain likes easy




harder to read




easy to read

*Processing fluency:* when something is easy for the brain, it feels good. We like it more.

*Reber, Schwarz & Winkielman (2004), Personality and Social Psychology Review*

*My main idea*

# Bad UI makes your brain ask questions.

# Good UI answers them before you ask.

*Every question is a little bit of work. Less work for your brain feels good.*

On the next slides: first, you have to guess. Then, you just know.

*Nielsen Norman Group: "Minimize cognitive load" (2013), "Few guesses, more success" (2025)*

# When will it arrive?

## You have to guess *Snowe: "Typically 4-7 business days"*




## You just know *Apple: "Delivers Thu, Apr 21"*




*Screens: Baymard Institute, Current state of checkout UX, 2026*

# What is wrong?

## You have to guess *GameStop: "Phone number is required"*




## You just know *Away: "Your card number is incomplete."*




*Screens: Baymard Institute, Adaptive validation error messages, 2023*

# What do these icons do?

## You have to guess *Linear 2026: icons only*

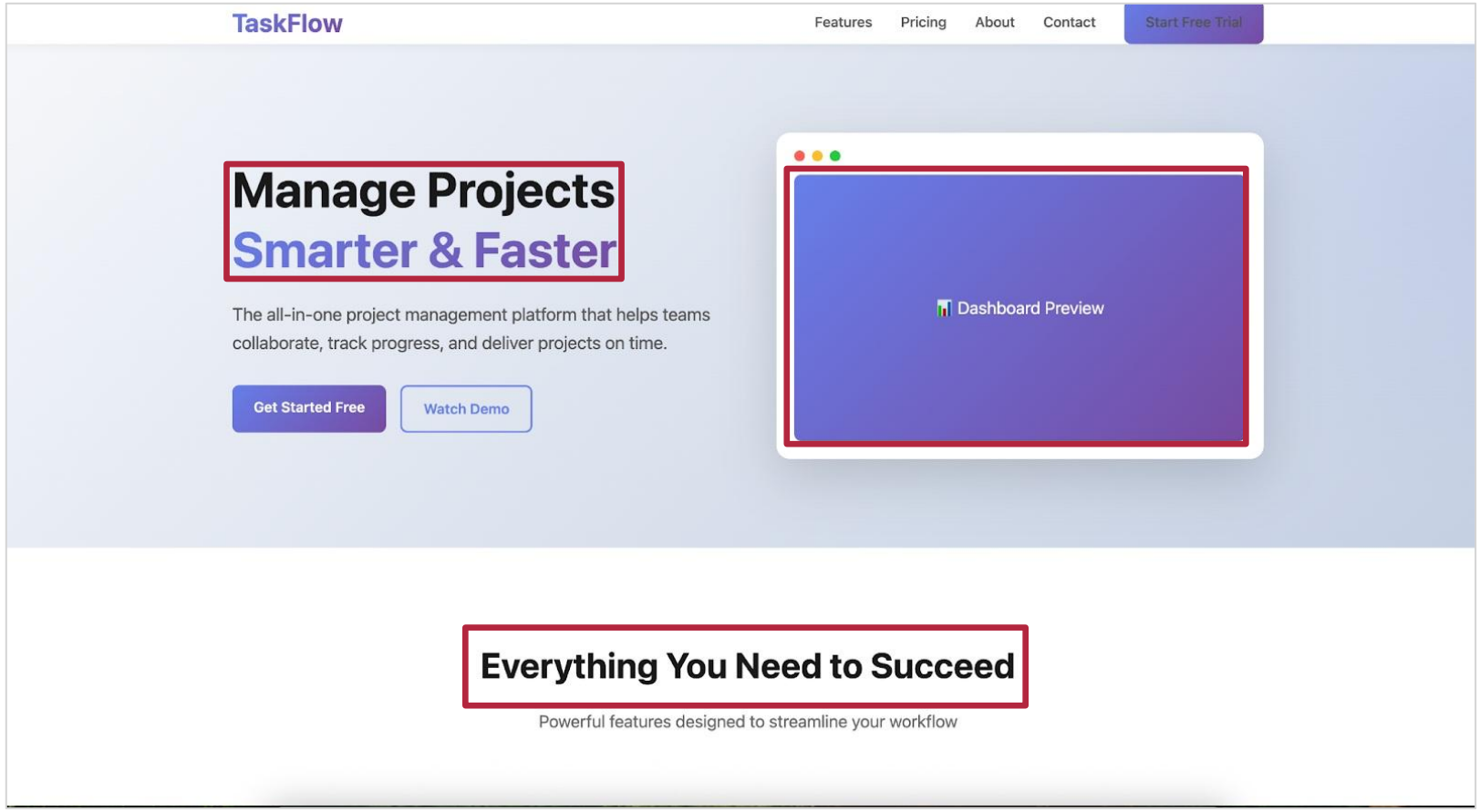


## You just know *Linear before 2026: icon + word*




*Screens: Linear, A calmer interface for a product in motion, 2026*

# Now look at AI slop




*AI-made page, no design rules given. Image: Anthropic, 2025*

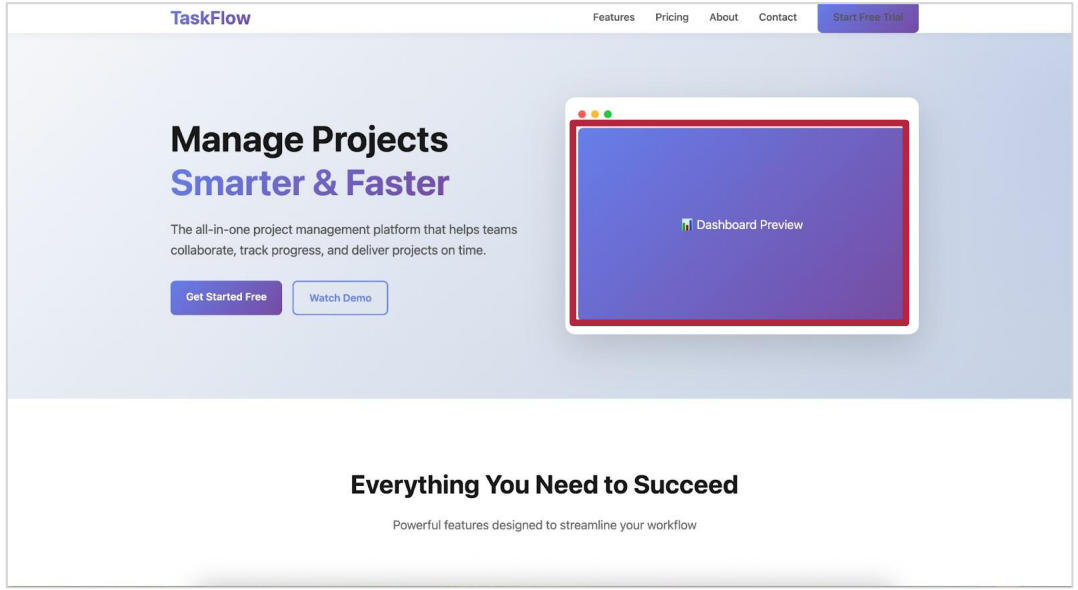
*"Smarter & Faster" than what?*

*Dashboard Preview: where is the dashboard?*

*Everything I need: for what?*

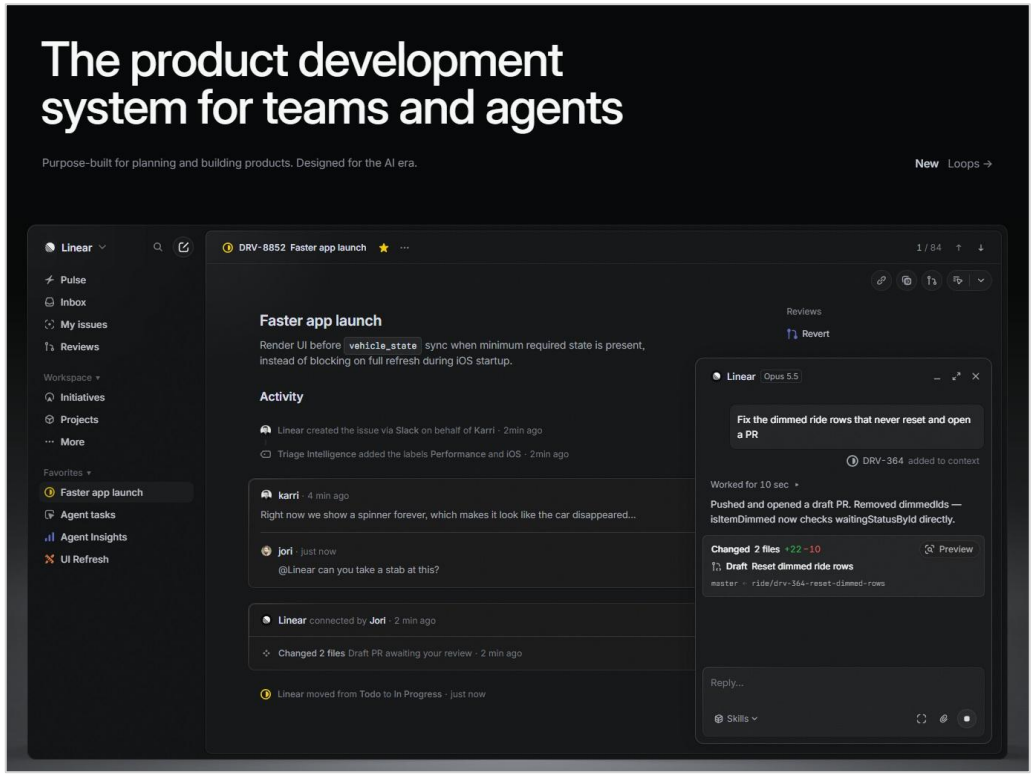
The page doesn't answer.

# What does the product look like?




A purple box

*AI-made page (Anthropic, 2025)*




The real app

*linear.app home page (screenshot, 7 November 2026)*

# To sum up

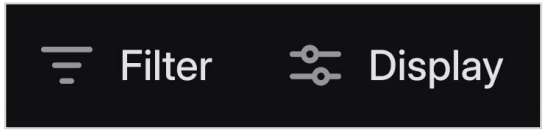
*When will it arrive?*




*What is wrong?*




*What does this do?*




Good UI answers your brain's questions before you ask them.

AI slop looks familiar, but it leaves the questions open.

Thank you! Any questions?

# Sources


1. Reber, R., Schwarz, N., & Winkielman, P. (2004). Processing fluency and aesthetic pleasure: Is beauty in the perceiver's processing experience? Personality and Social Psychology Review, 8(4), 364-382.
2. Whitenton, K. (2013). Minimize cognitive load to maximize usability. Nielsen Norman Group. nngroup.com/articles/minimize-cognitive-load
3. Wang, H. (2025, July 18). Few guesses, more success: 4 principles to reduce cognitive load in forms. Nielsen Norman Group. nngroup.com/articles/4-principles-reduce-cognitive-load
4. Baymard Institute. Current state of checkout UX (2026); Adaptive validation error messages (2023). baymard.com/research-articles
5. Linear (2026, March 12). A calmer interface for a product in motion. linear.app/now
6. Anthropic (2025, November 12). Improving frontend design through Skills. claude.com/resources/articles
7. Merriam-Webster (2025). Word of the Year 2025: Slop. merriam-webster.com/wordplay/word-of-the-year
8. Images: Baymard Institute research screenshots; linear.app; Anthropic; Willy's Chocolate Experience ad from Wikipedia's "AI slop" article (public domain).